EXPLORASELF

ALEXANDRU COJOCARI

99 BUILT TO LEAD

ONE LEADER IN THE MAKING.

99 PRACTICAL TOOLS

FOR FOUNDERS BUILDING WHAT MATTERS

A PERSONAL LEADERSHIP FIELD GUIDE

EXPLORASELF.COM

100 FRAMEWORKS

LEAD YOURSELF. GROW YOUR BUSINESS.

A practical field guide for the person behind the business.

100 original reflection and decision tools

Each begins with a real founder situation and ends with a choice you can examine.

SELF PEOPLE WORK BUSINESS

P.A.C.E.

The existing core loop behind the 100 tools.

P

PAUSE

Make space before the automatic response.

A

ASSESS

Separate facts, meaning, values and conditions.

C

CHOOSE

Name the decision you own and why it fits.

E

EXECUTE

Take a proportionate step and review it.

P.A.C.E. is one existing ExploraSelf method. The next 100 acronym frameworks are additional tools.

AWARE

Your first reaction is information. Your next move is a choice.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your reaction arrives before you have named what actually happened.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

A	Attend to the moment
W	What happened
A	Assumptions in play
R	Responsibility you hold
E	Experiment with a response

ASK YOURSELF

What changed in you just before the decision became urgent?

AWARE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A client questions a decision. You feel your chest tighten and want to defend the whole business.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A client asks why a deadline moved. You notice a flash of defensiveness, separate her question from your story about being judged, and offer a clear update.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What changed in you just before the decision became urgent?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SEED

A convincing story still needs evidence.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a small event has turned into a confident story about someone's motive.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	State the observable event
E	Experience the feeling
E	Examine the story
D	Decide what matters

ASK YOURSELF

What do you know directly, and what did your mind add?

SEED

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A colleague misses a handoff. Before asking why, you have decided they do not care.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The missed handoff is a fact. 'They do not care' is a story. Ask what blocked the work, then agree on a checkpoint you can both see.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What do you know directly, and what did your mind add?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TEMPO

Urgency is a feeling. Timing is a decision.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when urgency is pushing you to act before you have heard yourself think.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	Trace the trigger
E	Explain the emotion
M	Map the meaning
P	Pause for choice
O	Open one option

ASK YOURSELF

If you waited one minute, what would become easier to see?

TEMPO

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are about to accept a project because the silence after saying no feels uncomfortable.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A new project sounds flattering. Before agreeing, name the excitement and the fear of losing it. Check next week's capacity, then answer with a realistic date.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

If you waited one minute, what would become easier to see?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: Anger Is Expensive: The Founder's Workbook

exploraself.com/ebooks/anger-is-expensive-workbook

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SIFT

Separate what you saw from what you concluded.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your first explanation feels certain but the evidence is still thin.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	**Stop the automatic answer**
I	**Identify what is known**
F	**Find the interpretation**
T	**Test it with evidence**

ASK YOURSELF

What part of your conclusion is evidence, and what part is a guess?

SIFT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Sales dip for a week, and your mind jumps straight to 'the offer is wrong.'

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Sales were lower this week. That is the signal. 'The offer is wrong' is a hypothesis. Compare more weeks and ask customers before changing the offer.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What part of your conclusion is evidence, and what part is a guess?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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CUE

A repeated feeling may be pointing to an unmet need.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a recurring feeling may be pointing to a need you have not named.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

C	**Catch the signal**
U	**Understand the need**
E	**Explore a response**

ASK YOURSELF

What might this reaction be asking you to notice?

CUE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You keep feeling resentful about a meeting you agreed to attend.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You resent a standing meeting. The signal may be about time or unclear purpose. Ask what the meeting must achieve, then propose a shorter format.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What might this reaction be asking you to notice?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

FACT

Ground a charged moment in what can be verified.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when pressure makes facts, fear and assumptions blur together.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

F	**Frame what happened**
A	**Acknowledge your reaction**
C	**Check the evidence**
T	**Take a measured step**

ASK YOURSELF

Which fact would still be true if you felt calmer?

FACT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A late payment lands on the same day a team member asks for a change.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A late payment and a team request arrive together. Separate the actual cash timing from your irritation, then decide which conversation needs to happen first.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which fact would still be true if you felt calmer?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

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LENS

Values become visible in the response you choose.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the convenient response conflicts with the values you want to lead by.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

L	Locate the moment
E	Examine the assumption
N	Name the value
S	Select a response

ASK YOURSELF

What value do you want your next response to express?

LENS

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The quick shortcut would save time but would break a promise you value.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A shortcut could help you ship tonight, but it would break a promise. Name the promise, explain the trade-off and agree on a date you can keep.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What value do you want your next response to express?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TUNE

Listen to the need beneath the emotion.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a strong emotion is asking for attention but not necessarily action.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	**Tell what happened**
U	**Understand the feeling**
N	**Name the need**
E	**Explore a choice**

ASK YOURSELF

What need is present underneath the pressure to act?

TUNE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are angry after a client call and drafting a reply while still activated.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

After a tense client call, you want to send a sharp reply. The need may be for clarity or respect. Draft the response, pause, then state the concrete issue.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What need is present underneath the pressure to act?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

VIVID

Make a vague pattern specific enough to change.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you can sense a pattern but have not yet made it concrete.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

V	Verify the event
I	Identify the feeling
V	View the assumption
I	Identify the need
D	Decide a response

ASK YOURSELF

What are you seeing clearly, and what remains blurry?

VIVID

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You notice the same conflict appears around deadlines, but cannot yet name the pattern.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Deadline conflict keeps returning. Identify the last three cases, what was assumed in each, and the one handoff point that needs a clearer agreement.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What are you seeing clearly, and what remains blurry?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

PULSE

Check your signal before you commit the team.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a decision feels charged and you want to respond deliberately.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

P	Pause for a breath
U	Understand the signal
L	Locate the need
S	Select a response
E	Evaluate afterward

ASK YOURSELF

What is the strongest signal in you right now?

PULSE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A team member pushes back and you want to decide whether they are resisting or raising a signal.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

A wish to be capable, trusted or understood may sit beside the reaction. Ask what matters to this founder before naming a motive.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A colleague pushes back. Pause and notice your urge to overrule them. Ask what risk they see, then make a decision you can explain and review.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is the strongest signal in you right now?

What did you add in interpretation, and what else could explain it?

EXPLORE NEXT: Anger Is Expensive: The Founder's Workbook

exploraself.com/ebooks/anger-is-expensive-workbook

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

NORTH

A goal needs a direction you can live with.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a new goal sounds exciting but has not been tested against your real life.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

N	Name the direction
O	Observe today
R	Recognize the trade-off
T	Tie it to values
H	Hold one aim

ASK YOURSELF

If this works, what do you hope your life and work feel like?

NORTH

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A new revenue target is exciting, but the hours it may require are not in your plan.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A higher revenue target sounds good. Name what it should make possible, the time it may require, and one first move that fits the life you have.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

If this works, what do you hope your life and work feel like?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

exploraself.com/rise

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

ANCHOR

Ambition works best when it serves a named need.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the result matters, yet you are unsure what need the ambition is serving.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

A	**Aim at the outcome**
C	**Check capacity**
O	**Open options**
N	**Name the need**
H	**Honor human impact**
R	**Reality-check**

ASK YOURSELF

What do you want this ambition to serve?

ANCHOR

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You want to hire because you feel overwhelmed, but have not named what the hire must make possible.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You want to hire because the week is overwhelming. Specify the result the hire would own, the capacity you can support, and what might improve without hiring.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What do you want this ambition to serve?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

BEACON

Choose a future you would respect from inside it.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you are choosing between an impressive future and a future that fits you.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

B	**Become the person you choose**
A	**Aim worth pursuing**
O	**Others affected**
E	**Evidence from your life**
C	**Cost to consider**
N	**Next step**

ASK YOURSELF

Which future version of you would respect this choice?

BEACON

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are choosing between visible growth and a steadier business that fits family life.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Visible growth and a steadier business are both appealing. Picture an ordinary Tuesday in each future, then test one choice that protects what matters most.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which future version of you would respect this choice?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

exploraself.com/rise

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

DRAFT

Treat a direction as a draft you can test.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a direction is still vague enough to keep changing every week.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

D	Describe a direction
R	Record current reality
A	Articulate the aspiration
F	Fit it to your values
T	Try a small test

ASK YOURSELF

What is the smallest useful way to test this direction?

DRAFT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your priority changes whenever a new idea or difficult email appears.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Your priorities change with every new idea. Write one six-week direction, choose a small test, and review actual evidence before replacing it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is the smallest useful way to test this direction?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

exploraself.com/rise

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

MOTIVE

A goal can carry a hidden request for proof.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when achievement has become a way to prove, protect or earn something.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

M	**Meaning of the goal**
O	**Outline the outcome**
T	**Trace the trade-off**
I	**Identify the inner need**
V	**Verify your values**
E	**Experiment**

ASK YOURSELF

What do you hope the goal will prove, protect or make possible?

MOTIVE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You realize the goal may be about proving you can succeed after someone doubted you.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You notice the target matters partly because someone doubted you. Keep the useful ambition; decide which part of it still matters without that audience.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What do you hope the goal will prove, protect or make possible?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

exploraself.com/rise

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

HARBOUR

A humane plan starts with the season you are in.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your current season has less time or energy than your ambition assumes.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

H	**Hold the hope**
A	**Assess actual life**
R	**Recognize responsibilities**
B	**Bound the commitment**
O	**Offer one next step**
U	**Use a humane measure**
R	**Review**

ASK YOURSELF

What does this season of life realistically have room for?

HARBOUR

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A launch date assumes evenings and weekends that are already committed to other people.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A launch date assumes evenings that are already committed. Map real time and responsibilities, then change scope or timing before making the promise.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What does this season of life realistically have room for?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SCALE

Measure success against the cost of reaching it.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a goal looks successful on paper but may be asking too much of your life.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	State success in your words
C	Calculate the cost in time
A	Assess your agency
L	Locate life impact
E	Evidence of progress

ASK YOURSELF

What progress would matter even if nobody else applauded?

SCALE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The business target looks attractive, but the strain it creates feels invisible in the spreadsheet.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A target looks attractive on paper. Add hours, stress and family time to the picture, then choose a measure of progress you can sustain.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What progress would matter even if nobody else applauded?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

exploraself.com/rise

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

NEST

A goal needs a place in this season of life.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you are tempted to pursue a goal simply because it has been on the list for years.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

N	Name the need
E	Estimate energy
S	See the season
T	Trade one thing consciously

ASK YOURSELF

Is this the right goal for this season, or just a familiar one?

NEST

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You keep returning to a goal you set years ago, even though your circumstances have changed.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A long-held goal no longer fits current commitments. Name the need it once served and decide whether to adapt, pause or release it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Is this the right goal for this season, or just a familiar one?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

exploraself.com/rise

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TRUE

Choose goals you would still want without applause.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when outside approval is making it hard to tell whether a goal is truly yours.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	Target the goal
R	Review the reason
U	Uncover the hidden cost
E	Evidence that it still fits

ASK YOURSELF

Would you still choose this if you did not need to impress anyone?

TRUE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are preparing a big announcement partly because you want peers to see you as successful.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You are preparing a big announcement. Ask whether you would still make this move quietly, then keep the part that serves the work and your life.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Would you still choose this if you did not need to impress anyone?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

exploraself.com/rise

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

MEAN

Meaning becomes useful when it produces a move.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a meaningful intention needs to become one small, observable move.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

M	Mark what matters
E	Evidence from your experience
A	Aim at one contribution
N	Name a next step

ASK YOURSELF

What part of this goal feels most like your own?

MEAN

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You know the direction you want, but the first step still feels too abstract to schedule.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The goal may carry a desire for freedom, security, contribution or proof. Let the founder say which meaning, if any, fits.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You want to help more founders, but the aim feels abstract. Name one contribution and schedule the smallest useful conversation or piece of work.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What part of this goal feels most like your own?

What cost or trade-off are you willing to choose consciously?

EXPLORE NEXT: Allow Yourself to Rise

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GATE

A yes spends time and options. Name the threshold.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when several good options compete and saying yes to one means giving something up.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

G	Goal in view
A	Alternatives available
T	Trade-offs named
E	Evidence to gather

ASK YOURSELF

What must be true for you to choose this?

GATE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You have two client opportunities, and accepting one means delaying a commitment to the other.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Two clients want the same week. Define what matters in each commitment, what you must decline, and the evidence needed before saying yes.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What must be true for you to choose this?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

CLICK

Find the missing fact that could change your mind.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when one missing piece of information could change your decision.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

C	Clarify the choice
L	List the levers
I	Identify missing information
C	Count the human cost
K	Keep it reversible when possible

ASK YOURSELF

Which missing fact would change your decision?

CLICK

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are ready to decide, but one conversation with a key person could change the answer.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

One conversation with a key person might alter your decision. Ask for their view before committing, and record what you would do under either answer.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which missing fact would change your decision?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TIDE

Conditions around a choice change its timing.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when timing, people and changing conditions affect the same choice.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	**Time available**
I	**Impact on people**
D	**Direction it serves**
E	**Evidence you have**

ASK YOURSELF

What changes if you wait, and what changes if you act now?

TIDE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A supplier changes terms while the team is preparing for a launch.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A supplier changes terms during launch preparation. Check the deadline, people affected and evidence available; decide what can pause while you learn more.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What changes if you wait, and what changes if you act now?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

FORK

Compare paths by consequences and reversibility.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you are comparing paths but pretending one can be known to be perfect.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

F	**Facts first**
O	**Options side by side**
R	**Reversibility check**
K	**Keep a review point**

ASK YOURSELF

Which option keeps learning possible?

FORK

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Two options look equally strong because you are comparing only their imagined best outcomes.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Two options look equally good in their best-case stories. Write the likely downside of each, who would carry it, and how easily you could change course.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which option keeps learning possible?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

ORBIT

A decision has an orbit beyond your desk.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a decision affects more people or commitments than first appears.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

O	Outcome you want
R	Reversibility of the move
B	Boundaries around it
I	Information still needed
T	Test a proportionate step

ASK YOURSELF

Who or what sits in the orbit of this decision?

ORBIT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Hiring, renewing a lease and changing software are being discussed as one decision.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A hire, lease and software change are tangled together. Separate them, map who each choice affects, and test the smallest reversible move first.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Who or what sits in the orbit of this decision?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TRAIL

Keep a record so the outcome can teach you.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you want a choice to leave a useful trail of evidence for next time.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	Target for the choice
R	Reversibility
A	Alternatives
I	Impact to notice
L	Learning date

ASK YOURSELF

What would you want to learn from whichever path you choose?

TRAIL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A decision last quarter produced an unexpected result; you want a record of why you chose it.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Before choosing a channel, write the target, assumption and review date. When the result arrives, compare it with what you expected instead of rewriting history.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What would you want to learn from whichever path you choose?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SENSE

A strong choice has a reason others can follow.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the team needs to understand why you chose this path.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	State the decision
E	Evidence on hand
N	Need being served
S	Stakes involved
E	Experiment or commit

ASK YOURSELF

Can you explain why this is the choice that fits now?

SENSE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your team asks why you are changing direction and you need a clear, honest explanation.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Your team asks why direction changed. State the decision, the evidence and what will be reviewed, then invite the risk you may have missed.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Can you explain why this is the choice that fits now?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

LATCH

Slow down when the door locks behind you.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you are unsure how much thinking a decision deserves.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

L	Level of consequence
A	Alternatives
T	Time pressure
C	Cost of error
H	Help or perspective

ASK YOURSELF

How easy would this choice be to change later?

LATCH

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are spending the same amount of time on a reversible experiment and a long-term commitment.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A reversible pilot and a long contract deserve different attention. Spend more time on the long commitment and seek an outside perspective if needed.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

How easy would this choice be to change later?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SAIL

Move wisely with the information you have.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you are stuck at a threshold and need to decide whether to enter.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	**Stakes**
A	**Alternatives**
I	**Information**
L	**Learning after action**

ASK YOURSELF

What is a wise next step when full certainty is not available?

SAIL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You have a chance to partner with someone but have not tested expectations or responsibilities.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A partnership opportunity has a deadline. Name the stakes and unknowns, set a limited first step, and learn before expanding the commitment.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is a wise next step when full certainty is not available?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

WAGER

Every choice rests on a bet you can name.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you must act with incomplete information and want to limit the bet.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

W	What matters most
A	Alternatives
G	Ground truth
E	Exposure to risk
R	Revisit date

ASK YOURSELF

What assumption are you betting this choice on?

WAGER

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A large marketing commitment is due before you know whether the message works.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

The founder may want to move with confidence while protecting people, money or future options. Clarify what they most want to preserve.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A large marketing spend assumes the message is right. Test the message with a smaller audience and set the evidence threshold before increasing spend.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What assumption are you betting this choice on?

What information or perspective could change your choice?

EXPLORE NEXT: The Inner Boardroom

exploraself.com/unbound

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

BREATHE

Check capacity before you give another yes.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the week is already full and a new demand is arriving.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

B	**Body signal**
R	**Reality of the week**
E	**Energy available**
A	**Ask what can move**
T	**Time boundary**
H	**Human need**
E	**Experiment with a pause**

ASK YOURSELF

What can you stop, delay or renegotiate before adding effort?

BREATHE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A new client asks for urgent work while you already have promises due this week.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A client asks for urgent work. Write the promises already due, then offer a later date, smaller scope or honest no that you can stand behind.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What can you stop, delay or renegotiate before adding effort?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

MARGIN

A plan needs room for real life to happen.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when every hour is booked and no time remains for the unexpected.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

M	**Minimum commitments**
A	**Available capacity**
R	**Recovery time**
G	**Guardrails**
I	**Intent for the week**
N	**Next review**

ASK YOURSELF

How much unclaimed space does your current plan leave?

MARGIN

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your calendar has no open blocks, so a single delay pushes everything else into the evening.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

One delay pushes the whole week into evenings. Protect an unclaimed block and decide in advance what it is allowed to absorb.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

How much unclaimed space does your current plan leave?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

REFUEL

Rest can restore judgment when effort cannot.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your attention is fading and you keep trying to force another hour.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

R	**Rest need**
E	**Energy pattern**
F	**Focus leaks**
U	**Use of time**
E	**Ease to add**
L	**Learning from the week**

ASK YOURSELF

What small recovery practice would make a real difference?

REFUEL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You have stared at the same proposal for hours and every revision is getting worse.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You are revising the same proposal without improving it. Stop, identify what decision remains, rest, and return with one clear test.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What small recovery practice would make a real difference?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SPARE

The calendar can hide an energy deficit.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your calendar says yes but your energy says the plan is too large.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	Schedule truth
P	Pressure points
A	Available energy
R	Recovery included
E	Experiment with one boundary

ASK YOURSELF

Where is your week already full before you add anything?

SPARE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You planned a full week of output without counting client calls or recovery time.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The plan counts five full days but ignores calls and recovery. Add the true load, then remove or move one promise before the week begins.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Where is your week already full before you add anything?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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RHYTHM

A useful pace is one you can repeat.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a pace works for a few days but leaves you depleted afterward.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

R	**Recurring load**
H	**High and low energy**
Y	**Your time pattern**
T	**Time for recovery**
H	**Hold a repeatable rhythm**
M	**Measure the fit**

ASK YOURSELF

What pace can you sustain without borrowing from next week?

RHYTHM

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You can sprint through launches but need days to recover after each one.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You can sprint through launches but need days to recover. Plan delivery and recovery together, then compare the actual pattern with the pace you chose.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What pace can you sustain without borrowing from next week?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

STAMINA

Look at the conditions that produce your best work.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your energy changes and you need to understand the conditions around it.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	**Sleep and rest**
T	**Tension level**
A	**Attention quality**
M	**Movement and food**
I	**Inputs that drain**
N	**Needs to address**

A	**Adjust one thing**

ASK YOURSELF

What conditions help you lead at your best?

STAMINA

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You feel sharp in the morning and scattered by late afternoon; the plan treats every hour alike.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Focus is strong in the morning and thin later. Place demanding decisions in the stronger window and protect the rest for suitable work.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What conditions help you lead at your best?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

DOWNTIME

Recovery is a leadership responsibility.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you keep borrowing time from sleep, relationships or recovery to meet work.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

D	**Demand you carry**
W	**Work that can wait**
T	**Time to recover**
M	**Movement or rest**
O	**Options to reduce it**
N	**Needs you have deferred**
I	**Interruptions to limit**
E	**Energy to review**

ASK YOURSELF

What are you asking your future self to pay for this week?

DOWNTIME

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The weekend has become the place where you finish what the week could not hold.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The weekend has become a second workweek. Identify the recurring demand causing that debt and change its scope, timing or ownership.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What are you asking your future self to pay for this week?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

RESTOR

A responsible pause can prevent a poor next move.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a pause feels irresponsible even though your current load is unsustainable.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

R	**Recognize the load**
S	**Set a small boundary**
O	**Observe the response**
E	**Examine your limits**
T	**Try recovery**
R	**Rebalance**

ASK YOURSELF

What would a responsible pause look like today?

RESTOR

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You keep telling yourself to push through even as small mistakes multiply.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Small mistakes are multiplying. Pause one nonessential task, name your limit, and see whether a rested review changes the decision.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What would a responsible pause look like today?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

RECHARGE

More effort cannot always repair lost energy.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you are trying to restore focus by adding more effort.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

R	**Rest requirement**
C	**Commitments in view**
A	**Attention protected**
G	**Ground the plan**
E	**Energy level**
H	**Human needs**
R	**Rhythm to restore**
E	**Experiment for a week**

ASK YOURSELF

Which commitment takes more energy than it gives back?

RECHARGE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your focus is slipping and you are considering another productivity system.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You are considering another productivity app. First ask what work is draining attention, what can stop and what recovery would look like.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which commitment takes more energy than it gives back?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

BUFFER

A buffer protects promises from the unexpected.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you need space for interruptions without letting them consume the week.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

B	**Baseline workload**
U	**Unexpected demands**
F	**Flex space**
F	**Fatigue signals**
E	**Energy reserve**
R	**Review the buffer**

ASK YOURSELF

Where can you leave room for the real world to happen?

BUFFER

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

An unexpected client issue would erase the only space you left in the week.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to keep promises and remain dependable while needing room to recover. Capacity is part of the real situation.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

One urgent client issue would erase your only free hour. Keep a visible buffer and decide which work moves if that issue arrives.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Where can you leave room for the real world to happen?

What could you stop, delay, share or renegotiate?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

HEAR

Listening begins when your defense waits.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when someone is speaking and you are already preparing your defense.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

H	**Hold space**
E	**Explore their meaning**
A	**Acknowledge the impact**
R	**Respond with clarity**

ASK YOURSELF

What do you think they most need you to understand?

HEAR

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A team member shares a concern and you notice yourself preparing a rebuttal instead of a question.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A teammate raises a concern. Reflect what you heard before explaining your intent; ask which effect matters most to them.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What do you think they most need you to understand?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SAY

Clear speech carries care and a specific ask.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you know what you mean but the other person may not know what you need.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	**State the observation**
A	**Ask their view**
Y	**Yield room for an answer**

ASK YOURSELF

What is the simplest honest sentence you need to say?

SAY

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You ask someone to 'handle it' but do not say what outcome or authority they have.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You say 'handle it,' but no outcome is defined. State what result you need, ask what support they need and leave room for their answer.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is the simplest honest sentence you need to say?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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ECHO

Check what the other person actually heard.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the conversation ended but you are unsure what the other person understood.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

E	Event discussed
C	Concern heard
H	Hope or need
O	Options for next

ASK YOURSELF

What might the other person have heard that you did not intend?

ECHO

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A meeting seemed positive, yet the next morning the other person remembers a different agreement.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A meeting feels positive, yet both people leave with different actions. Repeat the decision and ask each person to name their next step.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What might the other person have heard that you did not intend?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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OPEN

A hard conversation can open without a verdict.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a difficult conversation needs to begin without blame or a pre-decided verdict.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

O	Offer the context
P	Point to the gap
E	Explore their view
N	Name a next step

ASK YOURSELF

How can you open this without deciding the other person's motive?

OPEN

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You need to talk about missed deadlines and do not want the conversation to begin as an accusation.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Deadlines were missed. Begin with the agreed dates and their impact, then ask what happened before deciding what needs to change.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

How can you open this without deciding the other person's motive?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

CANDOR

Honesty is useful when it can be acted on.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when avoiding the truth is starting to cost trust or time.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

C	**Context**
A	**Aim of the conversation**
N	**Name what you observed**
D	**Describe the impact**
O	**Open a question**
R	**Request a clear next step**

ASK YOURSELF

What truth can you say in a way the other person can work with?

CANDOR

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You know a concern could affect trust, but keep waiting for a less awkward moment.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You have delayed a concern for weeks. Name one observed behavior, its effect and the change you are asking for, then listen.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What truth can you say in a way the other person can work with?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

ASK

Curiosity can make a firm answer easier to give.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a request or disagreement has become hard to answer clearly.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

A	**Ask one open question**
S	**Stay with the answer**
K	**Keep listening before solving**

ASK YOURSELF

What would you ask if you were not trying to prove a point?

ASK

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You need to decline a request without making the person feel dismissed.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You need to decline a request. Ask what is most important to the other person, then explain what you can and cannot offer.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What would you ask if you were not trying to prove a point?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

CLARIFY

Shared words do not guarantee shared meaning.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when two people leave the same conversation with different interpretations.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

C	**Context first**
L	**Listen for their view**
A	**Aim of the message**
R	**Reflect what you heard**
I	**Invite a correction**
F	**Frame the request**
Y	**Yield space**

ASK YOURSELF

What expectation should both of you be able to repeat?

CLARIFY

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You leave a conversation replaying one sentence that landed differently than you intended.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

One sentence landed badly. Ask how they understood it, restate your intent and agree on the action that follows.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What expectation should both of you be able to repeat?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TELL

Feedback needs an example and a clear next move.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when an important message keeps getting postponed or diluted.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	Topic in one line
E	Example from the work
L	Link to impact
L	Listen for response

ASK YOURSELF

What specific example would make your concern easier to understand?

TELL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your feedback gets softened until the other person cannot tell what needs to change.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Your feedback is so soft that no one knows what to change. Give one example, explain its impact and ask for a specific adjustment.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What specific example would make your concern easier to understand?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

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PLAIN

If the message is buried, the work will be too.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you need to explain a choice so the other person can act on it.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

P	Point to the issue
L	Limit the scope
A	Ask their perspective
I	Invite a response
N	Next step together

ASK YOURSELF

What part of this conversation can you make simpler?

PLAIN

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You explain a decision in five minutes and the team still does not know what to do next.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A five-minute explanation leaves the team uncertain. Lead with the decision, its reason and the next action; save background for questions.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What part of this conversation can you make simpler?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SIGNAL

The signal is the one sentence they can repeat.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when more detail is making your message harder to follow.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	**State the key message**
I	**Illustrate with an example**
G	**Give the reason**
N	**Name the request**
A	**Ask what is unclear**
L	**Listen for understanding**

ASK YOURSELF

If they remember one thing, what should it be?

SIGNAL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A long message contains the right facts, but the ask is buried near the bottom.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to be understood and preserve the relationship without hiding what needs to be said.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A long note hides the ask. Put the requested decision at the top and check that the recipient can say it back.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

If they remember one thing, what should it be?

What do you need them to understand or decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: The EQ Dividend

exploraself.com/eq

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

BOUND

A boundary is clearer when it names your response.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your words need to carry a clear signal across a busy team.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

B	Behavior you noticed
O	Outcome it creates
U	Understand your need
N	Name the limit
D	Decide your response

ASK YOURSELF

What limit would protect what matters without punishing the other person?

BOUND

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The team is working from different assumptions because no one named the signal to follow.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A valued client writes outside agreed hours. State when you answer and what to do for genuine urgency, then follow that agreement.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What limit would protect what matters without punishing the other person?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SAFE

Safety grows from clear conditions, not vague reassurance.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a boundary is needed but you want to preserve respect.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	Situation described
A	Affect on each person
F	Fair need
E	Expectation to clarify

ASK YOURSELF

What would help both of you speak more honestly here?

SAFE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A valued client keeps contacting you outside agreed hours because the boundary was never discussed.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A process feels uneasy. Name the condition that is missing, invite the other person's view and agree on what would make the work safer.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What would help both of you speak more honestly here?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

THREAD

Trace tension back to the first missed agreement.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a person or process no longer feels safe, clear or workable.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	**Triggering moment**
H	**Hear both accounts**
R	**Respect what matters**
E	**Explain your view**
A	**Agree what is known**
D	**Decide what comes next**

ASK YOURSELF

What is the thread connecting the repeated moments?

THREAD

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A process makes you uneasy, but you have not identified what must change for it to feel workable.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A handoff has created blame. Reconstruct the actual sequence with both people and identify the point where expectations split.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is the thread connecting the repeated moments?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

BRIDGE

A repair conversation needs a bridge from both sides.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a working relationship feels strained and both sides may have a piece of the story.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

B	**Begin with shared purpose**
I	**Identify the difference**
G	**Generate choices**
R	**Reflect their view**
D	**Describe your need**
E	**End with an agreement**

ASK YOURSELF

What common purpose can you both stand on?

BRIDGE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A handoff creates friction and you know both people experienced it differently.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You want to reopen a tense exchange. Start with shared purpose, reflect their view, name yours and agree on one next conversation.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What common purpose can you both stand on?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

HOLD

A limit is real when you can hold it kindly.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a misunderstanding has created distance and a repair conversation is possible.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

H	**Honest fact**
O	**Own your part**
L	**Limit clearly**
D	**Direction you can offer**

ASK YOURSELF

What will you hold steady even if they disagree?

HOLD

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You want to reopen a tense conversation, but worry that doing so will make it worse.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You have said yes to repeated late requests. State the limit, offer an alternative within capacity and keep to the response you named.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What will you hold steady even if they disagree?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

FIRM

A request can be firm without becoming a verdict.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when people keep crossing a limit that you have never stated plainly.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

F	**Fact you observed**
I	**Impact on the work**
R	**Request you can state**
M	**Measure of follow-through**

ASK YOURSELF

What specific request would let the other person respond clearly?

FIRM

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You agree to every late request, then quietly resent the people who made it.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You want to support a colleague but keep taking their task back. Name the result they own and when you will review it together.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What specific request would let the other person respond clearly?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Anger Is Expensive: The Founder's Workbook

exploraself.com/ebooks/anger-is-expensive-workbook

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TETHER

Trust needs a checked action, not another promise.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when care for someone is making it difficult to name a necessary limit.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	**Tension noticed**
T	**Truth both can name**
E	**Experiment together**
E	**Expectations compared**
H	**Help needed**
R	**Review date**

ASK YOURSELF

What agreement needs to be updated to match reality?

TETHER

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You want to support a team member without taking their task back from them.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A repeated handoff problem has produced another apology. Agree on an observable change, who owns it and a date to check the result.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What agreement needs to be updated to match reality?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

MEND

Own the part you can repair in concrete terms.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you need to stay connected without taking responsibility for another adult's choices.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

M	**Moment to name**
E	**Effect you see**
N	**Need to understand**
D	**Do one repair action**

ASK YOURSELF

What can you acknowledge without defending yourself first?

MEND

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A promise to 'do better' has not repaired the repeated missed handoffs.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A tense meeting left a colleague unheard. Say what you did, ask how it affected them and make one change in the next meeting.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What can you acknowledge without defending yourself first?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

AGREE

An agreement is useful only when both can name it.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when trust has been damaged and the next step must be demonstrated, not promised.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

A	Aim together
G	Gather each view
R	Recognize differences
E	Expectation stated
E	End point agreed

ASK YOURSELF

What will each person do, by when, and how will you know?

AGREE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

People assume a meeting means a decision, while you meant it as a discussion.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

One person thinks the meeting made a decision; the other thinks it raised options. Write the decision status, owner and review date.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What will each person do, by when, and how will you know?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

KNOT

Untangle one thread before solving the whole knot.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when expectations are implied and people are left to guess what agreement means.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

K	**Know the facts**
N	**Notice your part**
O	**Open the question**
T	**Take one next step**

ASK YOURSELF

Which strand is fact, which is feeling, and which is a request?

KNOT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A short exchange has left tension between you and a key colleague.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may care about fairness and connection while needing an agreement that does not leave them carrying everything.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

An exchange has become tense. Identify the one fact both agree on, ask each person's need, and choose one next conversation.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which strand is fact, which is feeling, and which is a request?

What responsibility is yours, and what belongs to the other person?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

FOCAL

Attention needs a home before tasks multiply.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a knot of tension needs a small, respectful next conversation.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

F	Focus for this period
O	Outcome that matters
C	Capacity you have
A	Actions to consider
L	Limit the distractions

ASK YOURSELF

What one outcome would make this period feel well used?

FOCAL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The day's urgent messages are answered, yet the one important project has not moved.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Urgent messages fill the day while the main project stalls. Name one outcome for this period and reserve a block that belongs to it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What one outcome would make this period feel well used?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

NOW

The next task should serve the next result.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your day is full but the work that matters keeps moving to tomorrow.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

N	**Need in front of you**
O	**Outcome it supports**
W	**Work to do next**

ASK YOURSELF

What can wait without creating a real cost?

NOW

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your team asks you to approve every small choice because ownership is unclear.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Your team sends every choice to you. Decide which outcome matters now and which decisions another owner can make without waiting.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What can wait without creating a real cost?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

OWN

Ownership is visible in the next action.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the same tasks return to you because no one knows who owns the next move.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

O	**Outcome named**
W	**Who owns the next step**
N	**Notice when to check**

ASK YOURSELF

Where are you holding responsibility that needs to be shared or clarified?

OWN

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are about to say yes to one more request without seeing all the work already promised.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A task keeps returning for approval. Name the result, the decision boundary and the next check so the owner can move.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Where are you holding responsibility that needs to be shared or clarified?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TALLY

A yes needs a view of the full load.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when new requests keep arriving without a shared view of the total workload.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	Tasks in view
A	Aim behind each
L	Load they create
L	Link to priorities
Y	Yes, no or later

ASK YOURSELF

What is the full load behind the next yes?

TALLY

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A client message, a hiring issue and a product deadline all sound urgent at once.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A new request seems small. List the work already promised and what the new request displaces before answering.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is the full load behind the next yes?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SORT

Priority becomes real when something comes later.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when everything feels important and you need a deliberate order.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	**Stakes**
O	**Order by importance**
R	**Resources required**
T	**Time available**

ASK YOURSELF

What should happen first because of what matters, not who asked loudest?

SORT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You have work on the list that belonged to an earlier version of the business.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A client email, a hire and a deadline all sound urgent. Order them by consequence and time sensitivity, then tell the team what moves.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What should happen first because of what matters, not who asked loudest?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

LOAD

A plan can carry more than capacity allows.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when several commitments no longer fit the time or capacity available.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

L	List commitments
O	Owner of each
A	Available time
D	Decide what moves

ASK YOURSELF

Which commitment no longer fits the capacity you actually have?

LOAD

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A delegated task returns with a different result because the decision boundary was unclear.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Old commitments remain on the list after the business has changed. Identify which still serves the current aim, then remove or rescope the rest.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which commitment no longer fits the capacity you actually have?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

GRID

A handoff must include authority as well as a task.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a task is handed off but the recipient still has to guess the goal or authority.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

G	Goal of the task
R	Roles involved
I	Information needed
D	Decision owner

ASK YOURSELF

What detail would let the next person move without guessing?

GRID

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You lose focus each time you switch between client work, email and internal planning.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A delegated project returns with the wrong result. Clarify goal, inputs, decision owner and the one point where a check is needed.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What detail would let the next person move without guessing?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

BATCH

Switching work has a cost you can see.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when switching between unrelated tasks is draining your attention.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

B	Bundle similar work
A	Arrange a time block
T	Timebox the effort
C	Choose a stopping point
H	Hold a brief review

ASK YOURSELF

Which repeated task would benefit from a single protected block?

BATCH

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A project is described as 'nearly done' for the third week in a row.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Email interrupts client work every few minutes. Group similar replies in a protected block and compare the quality of both tasks.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Which repeated task would benefit from a single protected block?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

FINISH

A project finishes when 'done' is observable.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a project stays almost finished because 'done' was never made concrete.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

F	**Focus the work**
I	**Identify what done means**
N	**Name the obstacle**
I	**Initiate the first move**
S	**Set a check-in**
H	**Hold a brief review**

ASK YOURSELF

What will count as finished, in observable terms?

FINISH

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are ready to begin but the numbers, files or decision-maker are still missing.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A launch item is nearly done for three weeks. Define the final deliverable, its owner and the specific date for review.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What will count as finished, in observable terms?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

STAGE

Good work begins with conditions, not willpower.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when starting well depends on people, information or tools being ready first.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	State the outcome
T	Tools and people needed
A	Arrange the first step
G	Give it a time
E	Evaluate the setup

ASK YOURSELF

What needs to be ready before you begin?

STAGE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your team says customers want a new feature, but no one has named the customer conversation.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want quality work and visible progress, while the current system relies on effort no one has made explicit.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You are ready to start but the data and approver are missing. Prepare both before scheduling the work block.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What needs to be ready before you begin?

Who owns the next move and what can they decide?

EXPLORE NEXT: Unshakeable

exploraself.com/unshakeable

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

LISTEN

Customer evidence begins with a recent real moment.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you need to tell customer evidence from your own theory about customers.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

L	**Look for a recent example**
I	**Invite their words**
S	**Separate observation from guess**
T	**Test what you heard**
E	**Evidence to keep**
N	**Notice what repeats**

ASK YOURSELF

What did a customer do or say, not just what do you think they want?

LISTEN

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are discussing a client problem from memory instead of hearing the customer's account.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The team says customers want a feature. Find the last three requests, use the customers' words and test whether the need repeats.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What did a customer do or say, not just what do you think they want?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

FIELD

Go close enough to hear the customer's account.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when an internal conversation about customers needs a real customer example.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

F	Find a recent case
I	Invite the customer’s account
E	Explore what mattered
L	Learn what constrained them
D	Document the signal

ASK YOURSELF

Whose real experience would change how you see this?

FIELD

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A prospect asks for a discount and you need to understand what problem they are trying to solve.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A client problem is being discussed from memory. Ask the person who lived it to walk you through the last time it happened.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Whose real experience would change how you see this?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

NEED

The first request may hide the real need.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a customer's request may be only the visible part of their problem.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

N	Notice the request
E	Explore the situation
E	Evidence of the need
D	Decide what remains unclear

ASK YOURSELF

What are they trying to make easier in their world?

NEED

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Customer interviews end with 'sounds good' but do not reveal what people actually do.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A prospect asks for a discount. Ask what the current option fails to solve and what a better outcome would make possible.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What are they trying to make easier in their world?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

PROBE

A second question can reveal the useful context.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when customer interviews produce polite answers but little useful context.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

P	Prompt with an open question
R	Record their exact words
O	Observe what they do
B	Balance multiple accounts
E	Explore the difference

ASK YOURSELF

What follow-up question would reveal the context?

PROBE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

One enthusiastic buyer is shaping a decision for every customer you hope to serve.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Interviews end with 'sounds good.' Ask when they last tried to solve the problem, what they did and what stopped them.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What follow-up question would reveal the context?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

SCOPE

Know how far your evidence actually reaches.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when one or two conversations are being treated as proof of a whole market.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	Situation described
C	Customer's words
O	Options they tried
P	Pattern across examples
E	Evidence still missing

ASK YOURSELF

How many real examples support your current belief?

SCOPE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

People show interest, then disappear between inquiry, evaluation and purchase.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

One buyer loves a feature. Mark it as one case, then seek unlike cases before treating it as a market pattern.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

How many real examples support your current belief?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

TRACE

Trace where interest becomes hesitation.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the customer journey changes somewhere between need and purchase.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T	Trigger that starts the need
R	Response they try
A	Aim they have
C	Context around the choice
E	Evidence of what helps

ASK YOURSELF

Where does the customer's experience change direction?

TRACE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Your explanation says customers want convenience, but their behavior points somewhere else.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

People inquire and then disappear. Map what they see, ask and compare at each point before changing the offer.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Where does the customer's experience change direction?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

OBSERVE

Behavior can challenge a neat explanation.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when people behave differently from what your explanation predicts.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

O	**Occurrence to watch**
B	**Behavior recorded**
S	**Setting around it**
E	**Evidence collected**
R	**Response to explore**
V	**Variation to note**
E	**End with a question**

ASK YOURSELF

What are people doing that your current explanation does not cover?

OBSERVE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A drop in demand might reflect seasonality, budget pressure or your offer, and you do not know yet.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The team says convenience drives buying, but customers accept a slower option. Observe what else they value before making a claim.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What are people doing that your current explanation does not cover?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

CONTEXT

Put market signals back in their setting.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a market signal might be explained by timing, constraints or another outside force.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

C	**Conditions now**
O	**Other forces at work**
N	**Needs customers name**
T	**Timing and constraints**
E	**Evidence to compare**
X	**X-factors still unknown**

T	**Test the most important gap**

ASK YOURSELF

What outside condition could explain this pattern?

CONTEXT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You have described the market in detail but have not included a recent customer's own words.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Demand drops. Compare timing, customer budgets and competitor moves with your own changes before naming one cause.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What outside condition could explain this pattern?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

VIEW

A missing perspective can change the picture.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your view of a customer situation has not included the people living it.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

V	**Verify what happened**
I	**Invite another perspective**
E	**Explore a different explanation**
W	**Weigh the evidence**

ASK YOURSELF

Whose perspective is missing from your view?

VIEW

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A social post gets praise, but nobody takes the next action your offer requires.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Your description of a client problem sounds complete. Let a recent customer describe it in their words and compare the accounts.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Whose perspective is missing from your view?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

DEMAND

Praise is interest; action is stronger evidence.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when enthusiasm is being mistaken for evidence that customers will act.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

D	**Describe the customer**
E	**Examine actual behavior**
M	**Map their alternatives**
A	**Ask what they value**
N	**Notice willingness to act**
D	**Document what is unknown**

ASK YOURSELF

What has someone actually done that supports this demand?

DEMAND

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A project missed its goal, and you are trying to find the useful lesson without blaming yourself.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to help customers and grow the business. Listening keeps that ambition connected to what people actually need.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A post gets compliments but no inquiries. Ask what specific problem it addresses and watch whether people take the next step.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What has someone actually done that supports this demand?

Which part is evidence and which part is your explanation?

EXPLORE NEXT: First 100 Perfect Clients

exploraself.com/first-100-clients

LEARN

Learn from a result without turning it into a verdict.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a result hurt and you want to learn without turning it into a verdict on yourself.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

L	Look back without blame
E	Evidence of what happened
A	Adjust one assumption
R	Repeat what helped
N	Note the next test

ASK YOURSELF

What would you carry forward from this, not just get over?

LEARN

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A new leadership challenge asks you to do something you have not practiced before.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A project misses its goal. Write what was expected, what happened and what you will repeat or change next time.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What would you carry forward from this, not just get over?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

EXPLORE NEXT: Leadionaire

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

GROW

A new challenge can reveal a skill to practice.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a new challenge exposes a capability you have not needed before.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

G	Goal you held
R	Reality you met
O	Options you now see
W	Work you choose

ASK YOURSELF

What capability is this situation inviting you to practise?

GROW

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The business direction still matters, but the current launch plan is not working.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The role has grown beyond what you have led before. Name the skill it now asks of you and choose one place to rehearse it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What capability is this situation inviting you to practise?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

SHIFT

Change one variable so the result can teach you.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a plan needs adjustment but the whole direction may still be right.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	Situation to address
H	Hypothesis to test
I	Incremental move
F	Feedback to gather
T	Tune your next choice

ASK YOURSELF

What is one small change that would teach you something?

SHIFT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The evidence from a pilot contradicts an assumption in the original plan.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The direction still matters, but the launch plan is weak. Change one part of the offer or timing, then compare the response.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is one small change that would teach you something?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

EXPLORE NEXT: Leadionaire

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

REVISE

New evidence gives you permission to revise.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when fresh evidence makes an old plan harder to defend.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

R	**Record the result**	**E**	**Evidence you gained**
V	**View the old assumption**	**I**	**Imagine alternatives**
S	**Select a new test**	**E**	**Evaluate again**

ASK YOURSELF

What did the result teach you that the plan could not?

REVISE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A key employee leaves, changing what the business can reasonably deliver this quarter.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A pilot contradicts an old assumption. Keep the result visible, rewrite the assumption and test a smaller next plan.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What did the result teach you that the plan could not?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

EXPLORE NEXT: Leadionaire

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

ADAPT

Adjust the plan when conditions change.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when customer, team or life conditions change after you made a commitment.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

A	Attend to the change
D	Distinguish stable from shifting
A	Adjust your response
P	Practice it
T	Track what follows

ASK YOURSELF

What should change because the conditions have changed?

ADAPT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You have launched several initiatives but not reviewed what any of them taught you.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A key teammate leaves. Keep the mission, reduce what the current team can deliver and name the new review point.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What should change because the conditions have changed?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

EXPLORE NEXT: Leadionaire

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

CYCLE

Close a learning loop before opening another.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when starting new work is easier than closing the learning loop on current work.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

C	Choose the commitment
Y	Yield a clear action
C	Check the result
L	Learn from it
E	Evolve the next attempt

ASK YOURSELF

What loop is still open and consuming your attention?

CYCLE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A marketing channel stopped performing, but customer trust remains the reason you built the business.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Several initiatives are live with no review. Choose one, gather its result and decide whether to continue, change or stop it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What loop is still open and consuming your attention?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

EXPLORE NEXT: Leadionaire

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

REROUTE

Keep the purpose while changing the route.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the original route stopped working but the underlying purpose still matters.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

R	Reflect on the outcome	E	Evidence gathered
R	Reframe the problem	O	Options from here
U	Update the plan	T	Test a route
E	Evaluate the effect		

ASK YOURSELF

What part of the direction still matters even if the route changes?

REROUTE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Several small improvements are happening, though monthly revenue has not moved yet.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A channel stops performing. Keep the aim of earning customer trust and test a different route with a clear learning date.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What part of the direction still matters even if the route changes?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

EXPLORE NEXT: Leadionaire

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

PROGRESS

Progress can appear before the headline number moves.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when progress is real but one headline number fails to show it.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

P	**Pattern over time**
O	**Options available**
R	**Review what shifted**
S	**Share the learning**
R	**Reality today**
G	**Ground one step**
E	**Expand only with evidence**
S	**Set another check**

ASK YOURSELF

What is improving that you would miss if you only watched one number?

PROGRESS

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A failed launch reveals a constraint you never saw during the successful preparation.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Revenue is flat, but customer retention and handoffs improve. Record those signals while you keep watching the financial result.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What is improving that you would miss if you only watched one number?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

EXPLORE NEXT: Leadionaire

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

LIFT

A setback can reveal a hidden constraint.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a setback reveals a condition that success had hidden.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

L	**Look at the moment**
I	**Identify the lesson**
F	**Frame the next attempt**
T	**Try it on a small scale**

ASK YOURSELF

What did the setback make visible that success might hide?

LIFT

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A setback feels personal, and you need to separate what happened from who you are.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A launch fails even though the team worked hard. Identify the condition you did not see and design a small test around it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What did the setback make visible that success might hide?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

STILL

The result is real; it is not your whole identity.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you need to face what happened without making it your whole identity.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

S	Stop the rush
T	Tell the truth about impact
I	Identify what remains useful
L	Let go of the verdict
L	Lead the next choice

ASK YOURSELF

What can you learn here without turning it into a verdict on yourself?

STILL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The business is growing, but the life you hoped it would fund is getting smaller.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want to improve without turning one result into a judgment on their worth or potential.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A setback hurts. Name its impact without turning it into 'I am a failure,' then choose the part you can act on.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What can you learn here without turning it into a verdict on yourself?

What happened instead, including outside conditions?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

WHOLE

Growth should support the life you hoped to build.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when business progress is crowding out the life that progress was meant to support.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

W	What matters now
H	Human cost
O	Outcome you seek
L	Life fit
E	Evidence for your definition

ASK YOURSELF

If the business succeeds, what do you want life to feel like?

WHOLE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A new opportunity looks good for the company and raises questions about your health and relationships.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The business grows while personal time shrinks. Define the part of life you want back and identify one commitment to redesign.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

If the business succeeds, what do you want life to feel like?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

THRIVE

Success belongs to the whole person living it.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a goal asks for ambition, relationships and energy to be considered together.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

T Target worth pursuing	**H** Human benefit
R Relationships to protect	**I** Impact to create
V Values to honor	**E** Energy to sustain

ASK YOURSELF

What kind of success would you want to keep living inside?

THRIVE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

Every goal has become a bigger goal, and you cannot tell what would count as enough for this season.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

An opportunity helps the company but strains health and relationships. Name the benefits, costs and conditions under which the choice would fit.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What kind of success would you want to keep living inside?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

ENOUGH

Enough can be a deliberate measure for now.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the pressure to keep growing makes it hard to recognize what is sufficient now.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

E	**Establish enough**
N	**Name evidence of progress**
O	**Outside pressure**
U	**Understand the needs**
G	**Give the goal meaning**
H	**Hold a review**

ASK YOURSELF

How would you recognize "enough for now" without giving up ambition?

ENOUGH

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The financial upside of a deal is clear; the time and relationship costs are not.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

Every milestone becomes a larger one. Define what would count as sufficient in this season and when you will reconsider it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

How would you recognize "enough for now" without giving up ambition?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

WORTH

A reward must be weighed beside its human cost.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when the reward of an opportunity needs to be weighed against its human cost.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

W	What you value
O	Outcomes expected
R	Relationships affected
T	Trade-off accepted
H	Human quality protected

ASK YOURSELF

Is the gain worth the cost to the life around the work?

WORTH

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are close to a major milestone but have not decided what you want to protect afterward.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A deal has clear upside and a hidden time burden. Put both in the decision, then choose what you will protect.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Is the gain worth the cost to the life around the work?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

AFTER

Picture the day after the milestone.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when you are focused on the next milestone and have not pictured the day after it.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

A	Ambition named
F	Friends and family affected
T	Time required
E	Energy required
R	Review the whole picture

ASK YOURSELF

What do you want the day after success to look like?

AFTER

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The work is successful by external measures, yet your original reason for starting feels distant.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A major target is close. Describe the ordinary week after success and make sure the plan leaves room for what matters then.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What do you want the day after success to look like?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

ALIVE

Stay connected to the reason you began.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a goal is productive but leaves you disconnected from why it matters.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

A	Aspiration
L	Life you want
I	Impact on others
V	Values involved
E	Evidence of fit

ASK YOURSELF

What part of this pursuit makes you feel most alive?

ALIVE

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

The business is taking more attention while your friendships, health or curiosity go quiet.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The work is productive but feels distant from your original purpose. Name the contribution you still care about and change one week of work to reflect it.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What part of this pursuit makes you feel most alive?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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MOSAIC

A good life is made of several pieces.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when your calendar, relationships and personal meaning no longer fit in one picture.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

M	**Meaning**
O	**Others you care about**
S	**Self you are becoming**
A	**Agency in this choice**
I	**Impact**
C	**Care for the whole**

ASK YOURSELF

What important part of life is missing from the current picture?

MOSAIC

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A growth plan affects your partner or family, but they have only heard the final decision.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

The business takes more attention while friendships and curiosity fade. Put those pieces back in the picture before setting the next goal.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What important part of life is missing from the current picture?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

HARMONY

People affected by a plan deserve a voice in it.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when business ambition is creating tension with people you care about.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

H	**Human wellbeing**
A	**Ambition**
R	**Relationships**
M	**Money and meaning**
O	**Ownership**
N	**Needs spoken**
Y	**Yes or no**

ASK YOURSELF

Who needs to be part of this decision for it to fit your life?

HARMONY

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

You are celebrating a result without asking whether the way you reached it is sustainable.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

A growth decision changes family time. Share the real demands early, listen to what they need and revise the plan where possible.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Who needs to be part of this decision for it to fit your life?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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EQUAL

Quality of life deserves its own measure.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when success is being measured but the quality of the life around it is not.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

E	Experience you want
Q	Quality of life
U	Usefulness of the goal
A	Agency
L	Limits you accept

ASK YOURSELF

What would a fair exchange between work and life look like to you?

EQUAL

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

A difficult season is ending and you want to recognize more than the revenue result.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

You celebrate a result but feel drained by how it happened. Name one life measure to track beside business results.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

What would a fair exchange between work and life look like to you?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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Reflect, choose one proportionate step, and review what it teaches.

HARVEST

A season produces more than its final number.

WHEN TO USE THIS TOOL

Use this when a season of work is ending and you want to notice what it produced in you.

THE LETTERS AND THE MOVE

H	**Hope you began with**
A	**Actions taken**
R	**Relationships affected**
V	**Values lived**
E	**Energy spent**
S	**Signs of progress**
T	**Time to review**

ASK YOURSELF

Beyond the result, what has this season of effort produced in you?

HARVEST

SEE THE TOOL IN A REAL MOMENT

A FOUNDER MOMENT

After a year of effort, you want to name what changed in you as well as what changed in the business.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

They may want ambition to create a life they still want to inhabit. Ask what success should make possible beyond the business.

A WORKED EXAMPLE

As a difficult season ends, record what you built, what it cost, how people were affected and what you will carry forward.

NOW MAKE IT YOURS

Beyond the result, what has this season of effort produced in you?

What part of life does the current plan affect?

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WHAT THE TERMS MEAN

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Which inner voice has the chair when you make a decision?

WHAT THE TERMS MEAN

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Which force may be limiting the next stage of your growth?

WHAT THE TERMS MEAN

CLARITY: knowing where to go

STRATEGY: choosing a way forward

EMOTIONAL COMMAND: using feelings wisely

DISCIPLINE: following through

DRIVE: energy behind the aim

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THE EQ DIVIDEND

How are your emotional skills showing up in work and relationships?

WHAT THE TERMS MEAN

AWARENESS: noticing the signal

COMMAND: choosing your response

DRIVE: sustaining useful effort

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INFLUENCE: helping ideas land

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